

INTRODUCTION TO SPELL WEAVING

Spell weaving is a dangerous but powerful technique that allows spellcasters to modify their spells beyond their normal capabilities. While offering tremendous power, it carries significant risks that can permanently alter or even kill the caster.

THE NATURE OF SPELL SURGES

TO CAST IS TO READ WHAT WAS WRITTEN,
*however to modify spells is to create a whole nother thing... be
wary of the spells you weave*
— Eolande Lune, *Magics and Cataclysms*

Spell surges are modifications to spellcasting that tap into the raw nature of magic itself. This technique allows wizards to achieve effects typically reserved for sorcerers, but at great cost. Each use risks afflicting the caster with Mana Transmitted Disease (MTD), a progressive condition that warps both body and mind.

The dangers of spell surges are well documented in magical academies, where protection devices and strict protocols help minimize risk. However, the allure of additional power often leads young spellcasters to ignore these precautions, leading to tragic consequences.



BY DOMINIK MAYER



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EFFECTS AND RISKS

*“While we stop the spread of the disease and remove some of
the crystals on your skin,
I wont be able to reverse the damage done to your vocal
cords...
If it intrests you I can try and find you a position as a librarian
or an archivist?”*

— Lirien Lune, *Diagnose Note*

The effects of MTD manifest in six progressive stages, each granting both benefits and drawbacks. Early symptoms like enhanced magical detection and increased spell potency often mask the disease's true danger. By the time more severe symptoms appear - such as crystallizing vocal cords or flesh warping - it's usually too late for conventional treatment.

While magical institutions have developed treatments for MTD, they cannot fully reverse its physical alterations. This has led to strict regulations around spell surge usage and the development of protective devices.

SPELL SURGE RULES

When casting a spell of 1st level or higher, you can trigger a spell surge to enhance it in one of the following ways:

- Reroll one damage roll of the spell, taking the higher result
- Change one damage type that the spell deals to a damage type of another spell you know or have prepared
- Add double your proficiency bonus to one damage or healing roll of the spell
- Ignore somatic and verbal components of the spell for that casting instance
- Increase the spell DC to resist this spell by 1, for this casting instance

After casting the spell, make a Constitution saving throw (DC = 6 + double the spell's level). On a failure, you increase your MTD stage by 1. On a critical failure, also roll on the Wild Magic Surge table, triggering the rolled surge.

MAGICALLY TRANSMITTED DISEASES

Magically Transmitted Disease (MTD) represents the physical and magical corruption that occurs when a spellcaster draws too deeply from arcane energies. What begins as simple mana poisoning develops into a progressive condition that permanently alters the victim's body and magical capabilities.

THE NATURE OF MTD

MTD manifests through the crystallization of magical energy within the body. Each stage of the disease brings both enhanced magical capabilities and devastating drawbacks. MTD is resistant to magical healing, making prevention crucial for spellcasters.

The disease's progression shows a pattern of trading physical wellness for magical power. As crystals form throughout the body, spellcasters gain incredible magical abilities but lose basic functions like speech and natural healing. Some theorists suggest MTD represents a transformation rather than a disease, pointing to the final stage's creation of Arcane Souls as evidence. :

DISEASE STAGES

MTD progresses through 6 distinct stages, with the final stage resulting in either death or transformation. At each stage, the mage gains stacking boons, drawbacks and physical alterations. When the stage of MTD is reduced through treatment, the mage loses boons and drawbacks of the stage, but the physical alterations **never** disappear, forever marking the mage with scars of magic overuse.



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Stage	Boons	Drawbacks	Physical Alterations
<i>Mild stages</i>	—	—	—
1	You gain permanent effects of the <i>detect magic</i> spell	You make all Wisdom (Perception) checks with disadvantage.	Ocular changes (ex. iris color shift, eldritch symbols appear on the sclera)
2	Your spell save DC increases by +1 (stackable)	You make all attack rolls with disadvantage.	Eldritch symbols engrave themselves onto your skin, akin to an itchy rash.
<i>Severe stages</i>	—	—	—
3	You gain a 60ft. range telepathy and can ignore verbal components of all spells you cast	You make all Charisma (Deception, Performance and Persuasion) checks with disadvantage.	Your vocal cords crystallize, and your throat gets covered in crystals. You can never speak again.
4	Your spell save DC increases by +1 (stackable)	You make all saving throws with disadvantage.	Crystal growths emerge from the eldritch symbols engraved on your skin. The symbols still itch underneath the crystals.
5	Whenever you cast a spell, you regain an amount of hit points equal to 1d4 + the spell's level	You can no longer be healed by any means aside from the MTD boon, including short rests, but you still regain all your hit points when you finish a long rest.	Crystals start spreading onto healthy skin, cracking painfully as you move. Whenever you start to move while concentrating, you must roll a concentration check.

CRITICAL MASS

Whenever spellcaster's MTD stage increases to a number higher than their level, their body rapidly crystallizes. They are killed at the end of their turn, the process leaving behind a statue-like formation of magical crystals.

HUMANOID SHAPED LUMP OF MANA CRYSTALS

Material, Rare

The humanoid shaped lump of crystals used in creation of many magic items, the most popular being MTD protection devices.

THE FINAL STAGE

The sixth stage of MTD triggers a complete crystalline transformation. The victim's body converts to crystal from the inside out over the span of 6 seconds, while accumulated mana transforms their soul within the crystalline shell.

Upon completion, the victim's race changes to Arcane Soul, retaining their class and level but losing all physical possessions which remain in the corporeal realm.

TREATMENT OPTIONS

MTD is unaffected by magical healing but will naturally subside. While not using spells of 1st or higher level, your MTD stage will reduce at a rate of one stage per week for Mild Stages, or one stage per month for Severe stages. Alternatively, mana extraction at certified Mage Guilds can cure the condition at a cost of 100 gold coins per stage.

PREVENTION

Protection devices offer safer alternatives to risking MTD infection. These items allow controlled use of spell surges while minimizing exposure risk.

CRYSTALLINE CAP

Item, Common

A small crystal coin bent into a shape of a cap. When you trigger a spell surge, you can break the cap (no action needed) to grant yourself advantage on the spell surge saving throw.

SPELLCASTER'S FRIEND

Item, Common

A small, edible crystal pellet. You can consume it as an action, granting you a +2 bonus on the next spell surge saving throws you make before you finish your next long rest.

FAILED CRYSTAL FOCUS

Item, uncommon

A broken crystal orb covered in cracks. Once per long rest, you can activate it as a reaction when you make a spell surge saving throw, to automatically succeed that saving throw.

CRYSTALLINE FOCUS

Item, rare

A perfectly smooth focus crystal, which may serve as a spellcasting focus when placed on a staff. Once per long rest, you can activate it (no action needed) when you make a spell surge saving throw, to automatically succeed that saving throw.

LUNE RUNED CRYSTALLINE FOCUS

Item, Legendary (requires attunement)

An crystalline focus with runes engraved upon it, often placed onto silvery staves of the Lune family. This item serves as a spellcasting focus. When triggering a spell surge while attuned to this focus, you can automatically succeed the spell surge saving throw at the cost of reducing your current hit points by an amount equal to three times the level of the spell.

If wielded by a person affected by MTD, the focus will negate the drawbacks of their **current** MTD stage (but not previous stages) for as long as its wielded.

PRODUCTION AND LUNE

While its not known the origin of the crystals and its forging techniques, they may be found exported from the island on north east of the mainland ruled by the Lune family.

Those genius mages are sole producers and inventors of crystalline prevention items, turning them into the highest power in the spellcasting community among all mage guilds.



ARCANE SOULS

"DO NOT GO BEYOND THE SPECIFIED FORMULA!

Once you start and taste the power...

It is too late to turn back...

You won't even feel your humanity slip and fall...

Until... there is only mana left... Its smell.... so sweet..."

— Intrusive Thoughts of Lune Student

While most mages write their spells in careful formulas, some dare to rewrite magic itself. This art of spell surging - altering magical formulas in the moment of casting - offers incredible power at a terrible price. Each surge sends ripples through the caster's own mana, slowly warping both their magical essence and physical form. This repeated exposure to raw magic leaves them vulnerable to Magically Transmitted Disease (MTD), accelerating their transformation.

Those who survive repeated spell surging eventually reach a point of no return. Their bodies, twisted by MTD and metamorphosis, begin to reflect the raw chaos of their manipulated magic. Flesh becomes mutable, bones shift like liquid, and their connection to magic deepens. These transformed mages, upon reaching higher understanding of their new existence, become arcane souls - beings who dwell in a realm of pure magic, shaped by and echoing the physical world that vessels mana in its very matter.

An arcane soul's fate follows one of two paths. The strongest maintain their sanity to become powerful sages, guardians, or stygians. Others succumb to an endless hunger, drawn to underground crystalline caves rich with mana.

There they build colonies, growing crystal formations that reach toward the surface like hungry roots, seeking mortal vessels to feed upon.

ARCANE SURGE

When an arcane soul casts a spell, they can choose to use the mana forming their body to surge it - fundamentally altering its nature at the cost of their own vitality. Having already undergone their metamorphosis, they are immune to MTD's effects, allowing them to surge their magic without fear of further infection.

THE FADING

Arcane souls begin their new existence looking almost mortal, observing the physical realm while their minds grapple with constant hunger and the threat of other souls. Living between realms takes its toll - most eventually devolve into bestial entities driven purely by hunger. Those who resist this fate often seek contact with the material realm, their telepathic attempts manifesting as intrusive thoughts in mortal minds.



BY
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ARCANE SOUL TRAITS

Your arcane soul character has the following racial traits.

Ability Score Increase. Choose one of the following:

- Choose any +2; choose any other +1
- Choose three different +1
- Your Intelligence and Constitution scores both increase by 2, but your Charisma score decreases by 2

Age. Arcane souls are effectively immortal, though most eventually succumb to The Fading. Those who maintain their sanity can persist for centuries.

Size. Your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base flying speed is 30 feet.

Mana Sense. You don't perceive light or darkness. Instead, within 60 feet, you can see the magical density and shapes of objects and creatures.

Magical Nature. You are incorporeal and exist only in the realm of mana. You cannot physically interact with creatures or objects in the material plane.

Arcane Surge. When you use a Spell Surge, instead of making a Constitution saving throw, you take force damage equal to twice the spell's level.

Manifest. You gain an additional Spell Surge option. When used, your spells can affect the material plane.

Mana Hunger. You don't need to eat or drink, but must consume magical energy to survive. You can use an action to consume a spell slot from a willing creature within 5 feet of you, or absorb the magical energy from a dispelled spell.

Languages. You can telepathically communicate with willing creatures. When you attempt to communicate with an unwilling creature, your words manifest as intrusive thoughts.

GM Note While Arcane souls cannot interact with the physical realm, they can still summon familiars and other creatures into the material plane. Special items may allow other characters to summon an Arcane soul.

SUMMONING RITUAL

Ritual spell

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 5 feet

Components: V, S

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

You summon a willing arcane soul into the material plane. The soul manifests in a clearly magical form that cannot be disguised.

ITEMS

BLUE INKED SCROLL

Item, uncommon

This scroll is made of animal hide inscribed with shimmering blue ink. You can use an action and a bonus action to cast the Summoning Ritual spell from this scroll.

PACT PUPPET

Item, rare

This small mechanical vessel allows an arcane soul to attune to it. While attuned, the soul:

- Can speak verbally
- Shares its hit point pool with the puppet
- Cannot be healed by spells
- Regains 2d6 hit points when targeted by the mending spell
- Can be revived within 1 hour of death using smith's tools and expending a spell slot of 1st level or higher as an action

PACT JEWEL

Item, rare (requires attunement)

Once per long rest, while attuned, an arcane soul can assume the form of a familiar. While transformed, the soul:

- Uses the familiar's hit points and Hit Dice
- Returns to its previous hit points when reverting
- Takes excess damage to its true form if reduced to 0 hit points

LUNAR LANTERN

Item, Legendary (requires attunement)

This runed crystal lantern allows arcane souls within 60 feet to assume familiar forms. While transformed, they follow the same rules as the Pact Jewel for hit points and damage.

CURSED ARCANE BOND

Item, Legendary (requires attunement)

A ring which can be placed on a finger of an willing spellcaster. It forms a bond between an arcane soul and a spellcaster which allows them to use each others spell slots and known spells (using modifiers of person from whom the known spell was taken). While a bond is valid Arcane soul takes on a familiar form, the bond may not be broken until death breaks them apart.

While in the material plane:

- Arcane souls retain all racial traits
- Arcane Surge damage affects the soul's hit points, not their physical form
- Spells naturally manifest in the material plane from the familiar without using the Manifest feature